Whistleblowing Policy

Version: 1.0 | Effective: [Insert Date] | Review: [Insert Date]

Whistleblowing Policy

Policy Statement

[INSERT CARE HOME NAME] is committed to the highest standards of openness, integrity, and accountability. We encourage a culture where staff feel able to speak up if they witness poor practice, wrongdoing, or anything that may put residents, staff, or the public at risk. We recognise our duty to protect whistleblowers from victimisation or reprisal and to ensure that all concerns raised are taken seriously and investigated appropriately.

Purpose

This policy sets out:

- What constitutes whistleblowing
- How to raise a concern
- How concerns will be handled
- The legal protections available to whistleblowers
- Our commitment to supporting staff who raise concerns in the public interest

What is Whistleblowing?

Whistleblowing is the reporting of a concern, by someone working within the organisation, about wrongdoing, risk, or malpractice that affects others (e.g. residents, colleagues, or the public). This is sometimes called making a “protected disclosure”. You may be whistleblowing if you report:

- Abuse or neglect of a resident
- Criminal offences (e.g. theft, fraud)
- Health and safety risks
- Breach of legal or professional obligations
- Environmental damage
- Attempts to cover up wrongdoing

Who Can Raise a Whistleblowing Concern?

This policy applies to:

- Permanent and temporary staff
- Agency and bank staff
- Contractors
- Volunteers
- Students or apprentices

Speaking Up Internally

We encourage you to raise concerns as early as possible, ideally with your line manager or the Registered Manager. If this is not appropriate, or you feel your concern has not been addressed, you may contact:

- [Insert name/title] – Designated Whistleblowing Officer
- [Insert contact details – e.g. phone or confidential email]

You can raise concerns verbally or in writing. Concerns will be treated in confidence and investigated promptly.

External Whistleblowing

If you feel unable to report your concern internally or believe the issue is serious and ongoing, you may contact:

Care Quality Commission (CQC) Phone: 03000 616161 Website: www.cqc.org.uk Email: enquiries@cqc.org.uk

Other Prescribed Bodies (examples):

- Local Authority Safeguarding Team
- NHS England (for healthcare concerns)
- Health and Safety Executive (HSE)
- General Medical Council (GMC), NMC, or other professional regulators

Protection for Whistleblowers

Under the Public Interest Disclosure Act 1998, you are legally protected if you raise a genuine concern in good faith, even if it turns out to be unfounded. You will not be:

- Dismissed
- Demoted
- Harassed
- Victimised

for raising a whistleblowing concern. [INSERT CARE HOME NAME] will take disciplinary action against any staff who retaliate against a whistleblower.

Anonymous Reporting

You may raise concerns anonymously, but it may limit our ability to investigate. We encourage you to identify yourself so we can keep you informed and protect your interests.

Investigation and Outcomes

- All concerns will be logged and investigated thoroughly and confidentially
- The whistleblower will be informed of the outcome where appropriate
- Corrective action will be taken where necessary
- Safeguarding concerns will be reported to the Local Authority and CQC

Malicious or False Allegations

Raising a concern in good faith is always encouraged. However, deliberately false or malicious allegations may result in disciplinary action.

Training and Awareness

- Whistleblowing is covered in staff induction and ongoing training
- Staff are regularly reminded of their rights and responsibilities to speak up
- Posters and leaflets will be available throughout the home

Monitoring and Review

This policy will be reviewed annually or after any major incidents. Whistleblowing logs will be monitored to ensure themes and lessons are identified.

Related Policies

- Safeguarding Adults Policy
- Complaints Policy
- Code of Conduct
- Grievance and Disciplinary Policy
- Confidentiality and Data Protection Policy

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